IELTS Speaking Practice Questions

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How to use this question bank

Prepare every question in this bank aloud, one topic per session. Part 2 cue cards are built on these same topics, so if you can answer all the questions in a topic, you already have the ideas for any cue card on it.

- **Part 1** asks short personal questions: answer in 2–4 sentences.
- **Part 3** asks general, opinion-based questions: answer in 4–6 sentences.

In each topic, the earlier questions suit Part 1 and the more general, opinion-based ones suit Part 3. Useful sentence structures and filler phrases come first; vocabulary for every topic is at the end.

Sentence structures for Part 1

Use the **A + R + E** formula: **A**nswer directly, give a **R**eason, then add an **E**xample or detail. This turns a one-word answer into 2–4 natural sentences.

Purpose	Structure	Example
Direct answer	Yes, I really do… / Not really, to be honest…	Yes, I really do enjoy cooking.
Giving a reason	…mainly because… / The main reason is that…	…mainly because it helps me relax after work.
Adding an example	For example,… / For instance, last weekend I…	For instance, last weekend I made biryani for my family.
Talking about habits	I usually… / I tend to… / Every now and then I…	I tend to cook at home on weekdays.
Likes and dislikes	I’m really into… / I’m not a big fan of…	I’m not a big fan of fast food.
Preferences	I’d rather… than… / I prefer… to…	I’d rather eat at home than in a restaurant.
Past vs now	When I was younger, I used to…, but now I…	When I was younger, I used to hate vegetables, but now I love them.
Future wishes	I’d love to… / I’m hoping to…	I’d love to learn Italian cooking one day.

Full example – *Do you like cooking?*

> *Yes, I really do. Mainly because it helps me relax after a long day. For instance, last weekend I made biryani for my whole family, and they loved it.*

Sentence structures for Part 3

Use the **O + R + E + C** formula: give your **O**pinion, explain the **R**eason, support it with an **E**xample, then add a **C**ontrast or conclusion. Talk about people in general, not only yourself.

Purpose	Structure	Example
Giving an opinion	In my view,… / I strongly believe that… / From my perspective,…	In my view, fast food will never fully replace traditional food.
Explaining a reason	This is largely because… / One key reason is that…	This is largely because family meals are part of our culture.

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Purpose	Structure	Example
Giving an example	A good example of this is… / Take… for instance.	Take Eid, for instance: every family still cooks traditional dishes.
Contrasting	On the other hand,… / Having said that,… / While it's true that…	Having said that, young people do eat more fast food than before.
Comparing past and present	Compared to the past,… / Nowadays…, whereas in the past…	Nowadays people order food online, whereas in the past they cooked every meal.
Cause and effect	As a result,… / This leads to… / Because of this,…	As a result, obesity is becoming more common.
Predicting the future	I expect that… / In the coming years, it's likely that…	In the coming years, it's likely that healthy fast food will grow.
Partly agreeing	It depends on… / To some extent, I agree, but…	To some extent, I agree, but it depends on the country.
Concluding	Overall,… / So, all things considered,…	So, all things considered, traditional food is here to stay.

Full example – *Do you think fast food will replace traditional food?*

> *In my view, it won't fully replace it. This is largely because traditional food is tied to our culture and family life. Take Eid, for instance: every family still cooks traditional dishes together. Having said that, young people do eat more fast food than before, so traditional meals may become more of a weekend or festival thing.*

Filler phrases for difficult questions

Never stay silent: a short filler buys you 3–5 seconds to think and still sounds fluent. Use one filler, then start answering; don't stack several in a row.

Situation	What to say
You need a moment to think	That's an interesting question. Let me think about it for a second… / Well, let me see…
You've never thought about it	To be honest, I've never really thought about that before, but I'd say…
You don't know much about the topic	I'm not an expert on this, but I imagine that… / I don't know much about it, but my guess would be…
You didn't hear the question	Sorry, could you repeat the question, please?
You didn't understand a word	Sorry, what do you mean by '…'? / Could you rephrase that, please? (Part 3 only)
The question is hard to answer directly	It's quite a difficult question to answer, because it depends on…
You don't have personal experience	I haven't experienced that myself, but a friend of mine once…
You want to check your understanding	So, if I understand correctly, you're asking whether…
You want to add more time while speaking	What I mean is… / The way I see it… / How can I put it…
You lost your idea mid-answer	Sorry, what I was trying to say is… / Anyway, the main point is…

In Part 1 the examiner can repeat a question but cannot explain it, so if a word is unclear, just answer what you understood. In Part 3 the examiner can rephrase, so asking is fine.

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1. Home & Hometown

- Where is your hometown?
- Describe your hometown.
- What is it known for?
- What do you like or dislike about where you live?
- Do you think your hometown has changed over the years?
- How has your hometown changed in recent years?
- Is it a good place for young people? Why or why not?
- Would you like to live in your hometown in the future?
- Can you describe the place where you live?
- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- Which is your favorite room in your home? Why?
- How long have you lived there?
- Is there anything you would like to change about your home?
- Do you know your neighbors well?
- How often do you see your neighbors?
- Do you think it's important to have good relationships with neighbors?
- What kind of problems can people have with their neighbors?
- Are neighbors usually more friendly in the countryside or in cities? Why?

2. Studies & Work

- What are you studying? Why did you choose it?
- What did you study at university?
- Why did you choose that subject?
- What was your favorite course during your studies?
- Describe a subject or teacher you enjoyed.
- How did your university prepare you for work?
- Did you do any internships while studying?
- What is your current job?
- Do you like your job? Would you like to do something else?
- What do you like most about your work?
- Is your job related to your degree? How?
- What challenges do you face at work?
- Do you prefer working in a team or individually?
- Do you want to change your career in the future?
- What skills would you like to improve?
- Where do you see yourself in five years?

3. Daily Life & Routines

- What is a typical day like for you?
- What's a typical weekday like for you?
- What is the first thing you do after waking up?
- Do you prefer mornings or evenings? Why?
- How do you usually spend your evenings?
- How do you usually spend your weekends?
- How does your weekend routine differ from weekdays?
- Do you like to plan your day or be spontaneous?
- What's your favorite part of the day?
- Do you think routines are important? Why or why not?
- How do you manage your time every day?

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- Has your routine changed since you graduated?
- Is there a routine you would like to change?
- How has technology affected your daily life?

4. Leisure & Hobbies

- What do you do in your free time?
- What hobbies do you enjoy in your free time?
- How did you get interested in your hobby?
- How often do you spend time on your hobbies?
- Have your hobbies changed since you were younger?
- Do you prefer indoor or outdoor hobbies? Why?
- Is there a hobby you would like to try in the future?
- Do you prefer to spend your free time alone or with others?
- How important is it to have hobbies in life?
- Do you think people today have less free time than in the past?
- How has technology influenced hobbies?
- Do you think online hobbies are as valuable as offline ones?
- Can hobbies become a source of income?

5. Tourism & Holidays

Part 1 – Personal questions

- Do you like traveling? Why or why not?
- How often do you go on holiday?
- Do you prefer traveling alone or with others?
- What kind of holidays do you enjoy the most?
- Do you usually plan your holidays in advance?
- Have you ever been on a long journey?
- What is the most memorable holiday you have had?
- Where did you go, and who did you go with?
- What did you do there?
- Why was that holiday so memorable for you?

Part 3 – Discussion questions

- Why do people like to travel?
- Do you think tourism benefits a country? How?
- How has international travel changed compared to the past?
- What are the advantages and disadvantages of package holidays?
- How can tourism affect the environment?
- Do you think people will travel more in the future? Why?
- How does technology make traveling easier?
- Should governments encourage eco-tourism?

6. Food & Cooking

Part 1 – Personal questions

- Do you like cooking? Why or why not?
- How often do you eat at restaurants?
- What is your favorite dish from your country?

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- Do you prefer home-cooked meals or eating out?
- Who usually cooks in your family?
- Can you describe a memorable meal you have had?
- Can you describe a traditional dish from your country and how it is made?
- When did you last try a new type of food? What was it like?

Part 3 – Discussion questions

- How have people's eating habits changed in recent years?
- Do you think fast food will replace traditional food?
- How important is healthy eating in today's world?
- Should children be taught cooking at school?
- How does globalization affect food culture?
- What role does food play in cultural identity?
- Do you think cooking is a necessary life skill? Why?

7. Media & Technology

- How do you usually use technology in your daily life?
- What role does technology play in your studies or work?
- Do you prefer reading news online or in newspapers? Why?
- How do you protect your personal information online?
- Do you think people rely too much on technology nowadays?
- How has social media changed the way people communicate?
- Do you think technology makes people less social?
- How has technology changed education?
- What are the advantages and disadvantages of social media?
- Do you think young people spend too much time on their phones?
- How important is digital literacy in today's world?
- Do you think traditional media will disappear in the future?
- Do you think artificial intelligence will replace human jobs?
- How has streaming changed the way people watch movies or listen to music?
- Do you think people should limit their screen time?

8. Weather & Seasons

- What kind of weather do you like the most?
- How does the weather usually affect your mood?
- Do you prefer hot weather or cold weather? Why?
- What's the weather like in your hometown most of the year?
- Which season do you enjoy the most?
- Are there any festivals in your country linked to a particular season?
- Do you think people's lifestyle changes with the seasons?
- How often do you check the weather forecast?
- Do you think climate change is affecting weather in your country?
- Would you like to live in a country with a different climate from yours?

9. Shopping & Fashion

- Do you enjoy shopping? Why or why not?
- Do you prefer shopping in malls or local markets?
- How often do you go shopping?

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- Do you like to shop alone or with friends or family?
- What is the last item you bought?
- Do you think online shopping is better than traditional shopping?
- What kind of clothes do you like to wear?
- Do you follow fashion trends? Why or why not?
- Do you prefer branded clothes or local clothes?
- Do you prefer traditional clothes or modern clothes?
- Do you think people spend too much money on clothes nowadays?
- How has fashion changed in your country over the years?
- Do you think fashion is important in daily life?
- Do men and women shop differently in your country?
- Is fashion more important to young people or older people?

10. Health & Lifestyle

- Do you think you live a healthy lifestyle? Why or why not?
- What kinds of food are considered healthy in your country?
- Do you often eat fast food? Why or why not?
- What do you usually do to stay fit?
- How many hours of sleep do you usually get?
- What do you usually do to relax after a busy day?
- How important is exercise in daily life?
- Do you think young people are healthier than older people?
- What are some common health problems in your country?
- Do you think stress affects health? How?
- Do you think people in your country care about their health?
- Do you prefer traditional medicine or modern medicine? Why?
- How has lifestyle changed in your country over the years?
- Do you think technology affects people's health? In what way?
- What advice would you give someone who wants to live a healthier life?

11. Friends & Relationships

- Do you have a best friend? Can you describe him or her?
- How do you usually spend time with your friends?
- How do you usually make new friends?
- Do you think it is easy to make new friends? Why or why not?
- What qualities are important in a good friend?
- Do you prefer to have a small group of close friends or many acquaintances?
- How do you keep in touch with friends who live far away?
- Do you think childhood friendships last forever? Why or why not?
- Have you ever had a misunderstanding with a friend? How did you solve it?
- How important is trust in a relationship?
- Do you think people nowadays make friends more online or in real life?
- How do family relationships differ from friendships?
- What is the difference between a friend and an acquaintance?
- Do you think men and women can be best friends? Why or why not?
- What do you value most in your relationships with others?

12. Culture & Traditions

- What traditions are most important in your family?

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- Do you enjoy celebrating cultural festivals? Why or why not?
- What is your favorite festival or cultural event?
- What traditional food is popular in your country?
- How do weddings in your culture usually take place?
- Have you ever participated in a tradition from another culture?
- Do you think traditions should be preserved? Why or why not?
- How do young people in your country learn about traditions?
- How has modernization affected your traditions?
- Do you think traditional clothing is still important today?
- How are cultural values passed from one generation to another?
- What role does religion play in cultural traditions?
- Do you think people should always follow traditions?
- How do cultural traditions strengthen family bonds?
- In your opinion, are cultural traditions changing in your country?

13. Books & Films

- Do you prefer reading books or watching films? Why?
- What is your favorite book or novel?
- Who is your favorite author?
- Do you enjoy reading fiction or non-fiction?
- Have you ever read a book that was later made into a film?
- Do you usually read book reviews before choosing a book?
- Do you prefer watching films at home or in the cinema?
- How often do you go to the cinema?
- Who is your favorite actor or actress?
- What kind of film genres do you like most?
- Do you enjoy watching films from other countries?
- What book would you recommend to your friends?
- Do you think books are better than their movie versions? Why?
- Do you think reading books is more educational than watching films?
- Do you think films influence people’s behavior or thinking?

14. Sports & Games

- Do you enjoy playing sports? Why or why not?
- What is your favorite sport to play?
- What is your favorite sport to watch?
- Do you prefer team sports or individual sports?
- Who is your favorite sports personality?
- How often do you play or watch sports?
- Do you prefer indoor games or outdoor games?
- Have you ever attended a live sports match?
- What sports are popular in your country?
- Do you think sports are important for children?
- Do you think watching sports is as beneficial as playing them?
- What is the role of a coach in a team’s success?
- How do sports bring people together?
- Do you think e-sports (video games) should be considered real sports?
- What skills can people learn from playing games and sports?

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15. Dreams & Future Plans

- What is your biggest dream in life?
- What is your dream job?
- What are your short-term plans for the future?
- What are your long-term goals?
- How do you plan to achieve your goals?
- What challenges might you face in reaching your goals?
- Who inspires you to follow your dreams?
- What kind of lifestyle do you dream of having?
- How do you feel when you think about your future?
- Do you think dreams are important? Why?
- Do you think it is better to plan for the future or live in the moment?
- Do you think education helps in achieving dreams?
- Do you believe all dreams can come true? Why or why not?
- Do you think money is important for achieving dreams?
- What advice would you give to someone about planning their future?

16. Animals

Part 1 – Personal questions

- Do you like animals? Why or why not?
- Do you have a pet? Tell me about it.
- Did you have a pet when you were a child?
- What is your favorite animal? Why?
- Are there many wild animals where you live?
- Have you ever been to a zoo or a safari park?
- Which animal do you find most interesting? Why?
- Where did you first see or learn about it?
- What does it look like, and how does it behave?

Part 3 – Discussion questions

- Why do people keep pets?
- What are the advantages and disadvantages of keeping pets in cities?
- Should animals be kept in zoos? Why or why not?
- Why do some animals become endangered?
- What can governments and individuals do to protect wildlife?
- Is it acceptable to use animals for scientific research?
- How do people in your country treat animals?
- Do you think children should learn to care for animals? Why?

17. Colors & Celebrities

Part 1 – Colors

- What is your favorite color? Why?
- Has your favorite color changed since you were a child?
- What colors do you usually wear?
- What color is your bedroom, and would you like to change it?
- Do you think colors can affect your mood?
- Are there any colors that have a special meaning in your country?
- What colors do people wear at weddings or festivals in your culture?

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Part 1 – Celebrities

- Who is your favorite celebrity? Why?
- Are there any famous people from your hometown or country?
- Do you follow any celebrities on social media?
- Have you ever met a famous person?
- Would you like to be famous? Why or why not?
- Which famous person do you admire most? Why?
- How did you first learn about this person, and what are they famous for?
- Do you own anything with a special color? Why is that color important to you?

Part 3 – Discussion questions

- Why do businesses think carefully about the colors of their logos and products?
- Do men and women prefer different colors? Why might that be?
- Why are young people so interested in celebrities?
- Do celebrities have a positive or negative influence on young people?
- Should celebrities be role models? Why or why not?
- Is it fair that celebrities earn so much more than doctors or teachers?
- How has social media changed what it means to be famous?
- Do celebrities deserve privacy, or is media attention part of the job?
- Why do companies use celebrities to advertise products?

Vocabulary

Learn 5–6 words per topic and use each one in a sentence of your own. Words you have actually said aloud are much easier to remember in the exam.

Topic	Useful words and phrases (meaning)
1. Home & Hometown	**bustling** (busy and lively) · **peaceful** (calm and quiet) · **cozy** (warm and comfortable) · **suburb** (area outside the city centre) · **close-knit community** (people who know and help each other) · **get along with** (have a good relationship)
2. Studies & Work	**major in** (study as your main subject) · **hands-on experience** (practical experience) · **deadline** (time limit for a task) · **workload** (amount of work) · **career path** (the jobs you plan to do) · **job satisfaction** (feeling happy with your job)
3. Daily Life & Routines	**early bird** (person who wakes up early) · **night owl** (person who stays up late) · **hectic** (very busy) · **commute** (travel to work or study) · **unwind** (relax) · **stick to a routine** (follow it regularly)
4. Leisure & Hobbies	**pastime** (hobby) · **take up** (start a new hobby) · **keen on** (interested in) · **therapeutic** (helps you feel better) · **recharge my batteries** (get energy back) · **in my spare time** (in my free time)
5. Tourism & Holidays	**breathtaking** (very beautiful) · **off the beaten track** (not touristy) · **sightseeing** (visiting famous places) · **itinerary** (travel plan) · **get away from it all** (escape daily life) · **broaden my horizons** (learn new things)
6. Food & Cooking	**mouth-watering** (looks or smells delicious) · **home-cooked** (made at home) · **spicy** (hot taste) · **balanced diet** (healthy mix of food) · **junk food** (unhealthy food) · **grab a bite** (eat something quickly)
7. Media & Technology	**tech-savvy** (good with technology) · **addicted to** (can't stop using) · **screen time** (time spent on devices) · **fake news** (false information) · **user-friendly** (easy to use) · **stay connected** (keep in contact)
8. Weather & Seasons	**chilly** (a bit cold) · **scorching** (very hot) · **humid** (hot and wet air) · **pouring with rain** (raining heavily) · **under the weather** (feeling ill) · **mild** (not too hot or cold)

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Topic	Useful words and phrases (meaning)
9. Shopping & Fashion	**bargain** (good price) · **window shopping** (looking without buying) · **impulse buying** (buying without planning) · **trendy** (fashionable) · **casual wear** (everyday clothes) · **cost an arm and a leg** (very expensive)
10. Health & Lifestyle	**work out** (exercise) · **sedentary** (sitting a lot, little exercise) · **well-being** (being healthy and happy) · **stress-free** (without worry) · **get enough sleep** (sleep well) · **cut down on** (eat or use less)
11. Friends & Relationships	**trustworthy** (can be trusted) · **acquaintance** (someone you know a little) · **keep in touch** (stay in contact) · **drift apart** (become less close) · **have a lot in common** (share interests) · **through thick and thin** (in good and bad times)
12. Culture & Traditions	**heritage** (traditions from the past) · **customs** (usual ways of doing things) · **pass down** (give to the next generation) · **festive** (happy, celebrating) · **get together** (meet as a group) · **preserve** (keep safe)
13. Books & Films	**page-turner** (very exciting book) · **plot** (the story) · **gripping** (very interesting) · **blockbuster** (very successful film) · **adaptation** (film made from a book) · **binge-watch** (watch many episodes at once)
14. Sports & Games	**teamwork** (working together) · **competitive** (wants to win) · **stay in shape** (keep fit) · **die-hard fan** (very loyal supporter) · **work up a sweat** (exercise hard) · **sportsmanship** (fair and respectful behaviour)
15. Dreams & Future Plans	**ambition** (strong wish to succeed) · **long-term goal** (aim for the distant future) · **settle down** (live a stable life) · **dream come true** (a wish that happens) · **step by step** (slowly, one stage at a time) · **pursue** (try to achieve)
16. Animals	**endangered** (at risk of disappearing) · **habitat** (natural home) · **wildlife** (wild animals) · **loyal** (faithful) · **domestic animals** (pets and farm animals) · **animal welfare** (care for animals)
17. Colors & Celebrities	**vibrant** (bright and strong) · **pastel** (soft, light colour) · **role model** (person others copy) · **influencer** (famous on social media) · **in the spotlight** (getting public attention) · **down-to-earth** (simple and humble)

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